OTIS · USER GUIDE

AQS Checker

Checking the quality of advice files and recording the outcome

As an **AQS Checker** you check the quality of advice. Using the standard checklist, you review the **Advice Quality** and **File Quality** of each case, record what you find and give the case its outcome. Where something falls short, you set out what the adviser needs to do to put it right. Your work is what makes the firm's advice reviews consistent, fair and on the record.

Where you'll work

In the **OTIS portal**, on the **AQS reviews** page. Sign in with your usual work account.

Where you fit in

Your part of the journey is the AQS check. Some cases have a Tax check before yours.

Dashed steps happen on some cases only: the Tax check where one is needed, the AQS check unless the Tax team returns the case to the paraplanner, the adviser when something needs putting right, and T&C sign-off only for Insufficient evidence, Potential harm or a failed Tax check.

What you can do

- See the queue of cases waiting for an AQS check, and **pick one up yourself** with **Run checks**.
- Work on cases your **AQS Team Manager** or the **OTIS Manager** has allocated to you.
- Open the case details you need, including any Tax check already completed on the case.
- Answer the checklist section by section. Your answers are saved as you go.
- Record fail reasons, comments and File Quality fail points.
- Record **who carries each fail** – the adviser, the paraplanner or someone else.
- Write a **remedial action** for every fail point.
- Give the case its outcome, submit the check and save it as a PDF.

How a typical case works for you

1. Open the **AQS reviews** page. Cases waiting for a checker appear in two groups: **Tax review completed – awaiting allocation** first, then **New – awaiting allocation**. Each group is ordered oldest first.
2. To pick up a case, select **Run checks**. In **Start checks on this case?** select **Continue** (or **Cancel** to leave it). The case becomes yours, nobody else can pick it up, the checklist opens straight away, and the case is listed under **Allocated to me**. Your AQS Team Manager or the OTIS Manager may also allocate cases to you directly.
3. Work through the checklist. You can stop and come back at any time; the case then shows under **In progress**.

4. Where an answer falls short, record the reason and your comments, tick any File Quality fail points that apply, and say who carries the fail.
5. Choose the outcome: **Pass**, **Pass with issues**, **Insufficient evidence** or **Potential harm**, and answer **Remedial action required?** A Yes sends the case to the adviser even when it passes.
6. Under **Fail points and remedial actions**, write what needs to be done to put each point right. OTIS won't let you submit until every fail point has one.
7. In the **Submit this review** panel, select **Submit review**. The check is then locked and moves to **Completed**.

What happens after you submit

A **Pass** with **Remedial action required?** answered No closes the case and the adviser is emailed that it passed – unless the case's Tax check found something to put right. Otherwise the case goes to the adviser to put right. Only a case graded **Insufficient evidence** or **Potential harm**, or one that failed its Tax check, then goes to the adviser's T&C Manager for sign-off. The paraplanner is emailed a copy of your completed check.

What you'll see – and what you won't

You can see

- Cases waiting for an AQS check (a summary only, until you pick one up).
- Cases allocated to you.
- Checks you have completed.

You won't see

- Cases allocated to other checkers.
- The detail of a waiting case before you take it.
- An option to change a check after it has been submitted.

Emails you'll receive

- When a case is allocated to you – by your AQS Team Manager or the OTIS Manager, or because you picked it up yourself with **Run checks** – you'll get an email with a link to it.

Good to know

- Cases that have already had a Tax check are flagged **Tax reviewed** and listed first. They have usually been in OTIS longer, so please prioritise them.
- Each waiting case shows **Days in OTIS** and **Waiting for AQS**, counted in working days, plus its due date.
- Only pick up what you have capacity to finish. Once you take a case, other checkers can no longer see it.
- If you took a case by mistake or can't complete it, ask your AQS Team Manager to reallocate it. Your work so far is kept.

Need help?

If something doesn't look right – a case you expected is missing, you can't open a page, or an action is refused – speak to your team manager first. They can raise it with the OTIS administrator. When you get in touch, include the case reference and a short description of what you were trying to do.